

Razia

DRIVING CENTER

Welcome to Razia Driving Center.

This handbook has been created to help every student become a safe, confident, and responsible driver. It follows a step-by-step learning approach, beginning with the basics of vehicle controls and progressing to driving safely in real traffic.

Whether you have never driven a car before or want to improve your skills, this guide will support your learning throughout the course.

Learning Objectives

By the end of this training, you will be able to:

- Understand the basic parts and controls of a car.
- Start and stop the vehicle safely.
- Change gears smoothly.
- Steer with confidence.
- Follow traffic signs and road markings.
- Drive safely in city traffic.
- Park correctly using different methods.
- Prepare for your driving test.
- Practice defensive and responsible driving.

Safety First

Always remember these rules before driving:

1. Wear your seat belt.
2. Adjust your seat and mirrors.
3. Check your surroundings before moving.
4. Obey all traffic laws.
5. Never use a mobile phone while driving.
6. Keep a safe distance from other vehicles.
7. Stay calm and focused at all times.

Safe driving saves lives.

Lesson 1 – Know Your Vehicle

Before driving, learn the main controls.

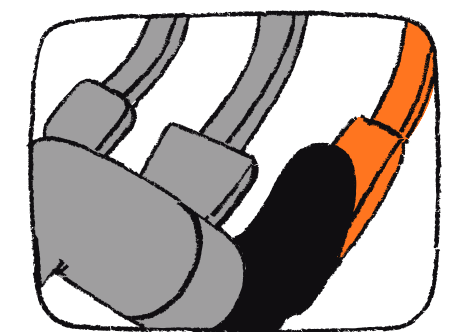
Steering Wheel

Used to control the direction of the vehicle. Hold it firmly with both hands in a comfortable position.



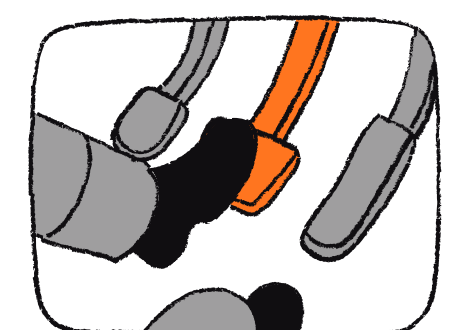
Accelerator

The right pedal. Press gently to increase speed.



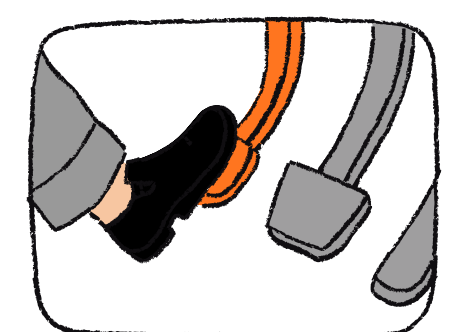
Brake

The middle pedal (or left pedal in automatic cars). Used to slow down or stop the vehicle safely.



Clutch (Manual Cars)

The left pedal. Used for changing gears and moving the vehicle smoothly.



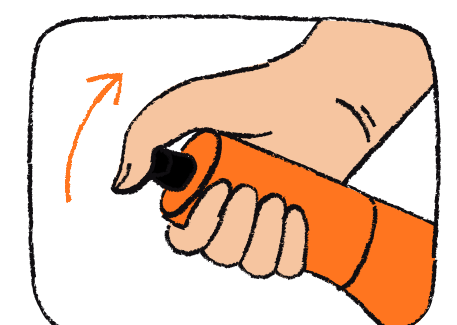
Gear Lever

Selects the appropriate gear for different driving speeds.



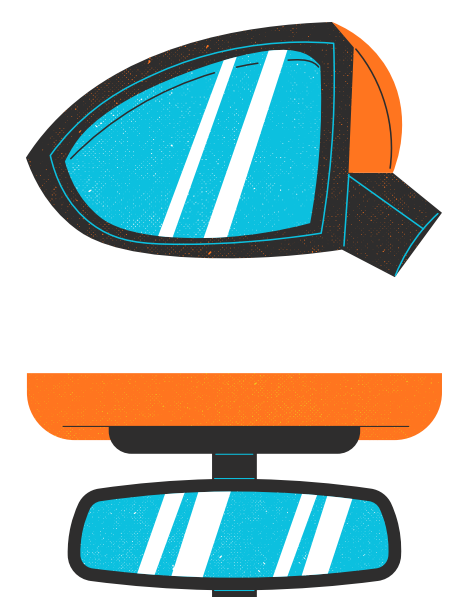
Handbrake

Selects the appropriate gear for different driving speeds.



Mirrors

- Rear-view mirror
- Left side mirror
- Right side mirror



Adjust all mirrors before moving the vehicle

Lesson Summary

Before your first drive, you should be able to:

- ☐ Identify all pedals
- ☐ Identify the gear lever
- ☐ Locate the handbrake
- ☐ Adjust the driver's seat
- ☐ Adjust all mirrors
- ☐ Fasten your seat belt correctly

Remember: Good drivers build safe habits before they start the engine.

Chapter 2 – Dashboard Warning Lights & Vehicle Controls



Learning Objectives

After completing this chapter, you will be able to:

- Identify the most important dashboard warning lights.
- Understand the purpose of each vehicle control.
- Recognize warning signs that require immediate attention.
- Drive with greater confidence and safety.

What Is the Dashboard?

The dashboard is the control panel located directly in front of the driver. It displays important information about the vehicle's speed, engine performance, fuel level, and safety systems through gauges and warning lights.

Never ignore a red warning light. If a red warning light appears while driving, stop the vehicle in a safe location and determine the cause before continuing.

Instrument Cluster

The instrument cluster usually includes:

- Speedometer
- Tachometer (RPM Meter)
- Fuel Gauge
- Engine Temperature Gauge
- Odometer
- Trip Meter
- Warning Lights

Common Dashboard Warning Lights

Engine Check Light

Color: Yellow or Orange



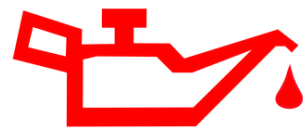
Indicates a possible engine or emissions system problem.

Action:

- Drive carefully.
- If the light flashes, stop driving immediately and have the vehicle inspected.

Oil Pressure Warning Light

Color: Red 

SIGN 

Indicates low engine oil pressure.

Action:

- Stop the engine immediately.
- Check the engine oil level.
- Do not continue driving if the light remains on.

Brake Warning Light

Color: Red 

SIGN 

Indicates:

- Parking brake is engaged.
- Low brake fluid.
- Brake system fault.

Action:

Release the parking brake. If the light remains on, inspect the braking system before driving.

Door Open Warning

SIGN 

Shows that one or more doors, the trunk, or the hood is not fully closed.

Turn Signal Indicator

Color: Green 

SIGN 

Flashes when the left or right turn signal is activated.

If it flashes unusually fast, check for a burned-out indicator bulb.

Battery Charging Warning Light

Color: Red 

SIGN 

Indicates the battery is not charging correctly.

Possible Causes:

- Faulty alternator
- Loose or damaged belt
- Battery problem

Seat Belt Reminder

Color: Red 

SIGN 

Reminds the driver and passengers to fasten their seat belts.

Always wear your seat belt before moving the vehicle.

High Beam Indicator

Color: Blue 

SIGN 

Shows that the high-beam headlights are switched on.

Use high beams only when they will not dazzle other road users.

Fuel Warning Light

Indicates that the fuel level is low.

Refuel as soon as possible to avoid running out of fuel.

Engine Temperature Warning

Color: Red 

SIGN 

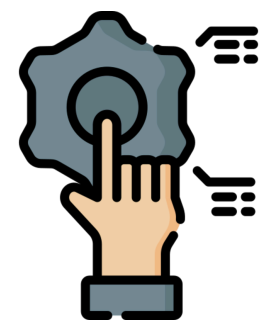
Indicates the engine is overheating.

Action:

- Stop safely.
- Turn off the engine.
- Allow it to cool before opening the radiator cap.

Never open a hot radiator cap.

Vehicle Controls



Ignition Switch / Start Button

Used to start and stop the engine.

Steering Wheel

Controls the direction of the vehicle.

Always keep both hands on the steering wheel whenever possible.

Horn

Used to warn other road users of your presence.

Use only when necessary.

Headlight Switch

Controls:

- Parking lights
- Low beam headlights
- High beam headlights

Use headlights during poor visibility, rain, fog, or at night.

Windshield Wipers

Used to remove rain, dust, or mud from the windshield.

Adjust the speed according to weather conditions.

Chapter Summary

Before continuing to the next chapter, you should be able to:

- ☐ Identify the speedometer and tachometer.
- ☐ Understand the meaning of common warning lights.
- ☐ Recognize the difference between red, yellow, green, and blue indicators.
- ☐ Operate the headlights, indicators, horn, and windshield wipers correctly.
- ☐ Know when to stop the vehicle if a warning light appears.

Remember: A safe driver pays attention not only to the road but also to the vehicle's condition.

Climate Controls

Operate the heating, ventilation, and air conditioning (A/C) systems.

Proper ventilation helps prevent windshield fogging.

Safety Tips

- Check the dashboard every time you start the vehicle.
- Never ignore red warning lights.
- Keep enough fuel for your journey.
- Monitor the engine temperature regularly.
- Learn the meaning of every warning light in your vehicle.

Dipper (Headlight Dimmer)

The dipper is a lever located on the left side of the steering column. It is used to switch between **low beam** and **high beam** headlights and to briefly flash the headlights.

How to Use

- Turn on the headlights using the headlight switch.
- **Push the dipper lever forward** to activate the **high beam**.
- **Pull the lever back** to return to the **low beam**.
- **Pull the lever toward you briefly** to flash the headlights without changing the beam setting (on most vehicles).

When to Use

- Use **low beam** when driving in city traffic, during rain or fog, or when another vehicle is approaching.
- Use **high beam** only on dark roads with no oncoming or nearby vehicles.
- Use the **headlight flash** only when necessary to warn or alert other road users.

Safety Tip: Always switch to **low beam** when another vehicle approaches to avoid dazzling the other driver.

Chapter 3 – Correct Driving Position & Pre-Drive Safety Check

Learning Objectives

After completing this chapter, you will be able to:

- Adjust the driver's seat correctly.
- Position the steering wheel comfortably.
- Adjust all mirrors for maximum visibility.
- Wear the seat belt correctly.
- Perform a complete pre-drive safety check.

Why Driving Position Matters

A correct driving position improves comfort, vehicle control, and reaction time. An improper position can cause fatigue and reduce your ability to steer, brake, and respond quickly in an emergency.

Step 1 – Adjust the Driver's Seat

Before starting the engine, adjust your seat so you can comfortably reach all controls.

Seat Distance

Adjust the seat so that:

- You can fully press the clutch (manual) or brake (automatic) without stretching.
- Your knees remain slightly bent when the pedals are fully pressed.

Seat Height

Adjust the seat high enough to provide a clear view of the road while maintaining at least 8–10 cm (3–4 inches) of space between your head and the roof.

Seat Backrest

Recline the backrest slightly (approximately 100°–110°). Your shoulders should remain in contact with the seat while holding the steering wheel.

Step 2 – Adjust the Steering Wheel

Adjust the steering wheel so that:

- Your arms remain slightly bent.
- Your shoulders stay against the seat.
- The wheel does not block your view of the instrument cluster.

Correct Hand Position

Place your hands at the **9 o'clock** and **3 o'clock** positions on the steering wheel.

This position provides better control and reduces the risk of injury if the airbag deploys.

Step 3 – Adjust the Mirrors

Always adjust the mirrors before moving the vehicle.

Rear-View Mirror

Position the mirror so you can see the entire rear window.

Left Side Mirror

Adjust to show:

- A small portion of your vehicle.
- The adjacent traffic lane.

Right Side Mirror

Adjust using the same method as the left mirror.

Remember: Mirrors reduce blind spots but do not eliminate them completely.

Always perform a shoulder check before changing lanes.

Step 4 – Wear Your Seat Belt

Fasten your seat belt before starting the engine.

Correct Seat Belt Position

- The lap belt should fit low across your hips.
- The shoulder belt should cross the center of your chest and shoulder.
- Never place the shoulder belt under your arm or behind your back.

Ensure all passengers are wearing their seat belts before the journey begins.

Step 5 – Pre-Drive Safety Check

Before moving the vehicle, perform the following checks:

- ☐ Seat adjusted correctly.
- ☐ Steering wheel adjusted.
- ☐ Rear-view mirror adjusted.
- ☐ Left mirror adjusted.
- ☐ Right mirror adjusted.
- ☐ Seat belt fastened.
- ☐ Doors fully closed.
- ☐ Parking brake applied.
- ☐ Gear lever in Neutral (Manual) or Park (Automatic).
- ☐ Dashboard warning lights checked.
- ☐ Surroundings clear of pedestrians and obstacles.

The S.M.A.R.T. Check

Remember this simple routine before every drive:

S – Seat: Adjust your seat.

M – Mirrors: Adjust all mirrors.

A – Always wear your seat belt.

R – Release the parking brake only when ready to move.

T – Traffic: Check all around before moving.

Chapter Summary

Before continuing to Chapter 4, you should be able to:

- ☐ Adjust the driver's seat correctly.
- ☐ Hold the steering wheel at the 9 and 3 o'clock positions.
- ☐ Adjust all three mirrors.
- ☐ Wear the seat belt correctly.
- ☐ Complete the full pre-drive safety check.

Remember: Every safe journey begins with the correct driving position and a proper safety check.

Chapter 4 – Starting, Moving Off & Stopping the Vehicle

Learning Objectives

After completing this chapter, you will be able to:

- Perform the correct procedure before starting the engine.
 - Start both manual and automatic vehicles safely.
 - Move off smoothly without stalling.
 - Stop the vehicle safely and correctly.
-

Before Starting the Engine

Always complete these safety checks:

- ☐ Adjust the driver's seat.
 - ☐ Adjust all mirrors.
 - ☐ Fasten your seat belt.
 - ☐ Ensure all doors are fully closed.
 - ☐ Check the area around the vehicle.
 - ☐ Apply the parking brake.
-

Starting a Manual Transmission Vehicle

1. Sit in the correct driving position.
 2. Press the **clutch pedal fully**.
 3. Ensure the gear lever is in **Neutral (N)**.
 4. Start the engine.
 5. Check the dashboard for warning lights.
 6. Keep the clutch pedal fully pressed until you are ready to select a gear.
-

Starting an Automatic Transmission Vehicle

1. Press and hold the **brake pedal**.
 2. Ensure the gear selector is in **Park (P)** or **Neutral (N)**.
 3. Start the engine.
 4. Check the dashboard for warning lights.
 5. Keep your foot on the brake until you are ready to drive.
-

Moving Off (Manual Transmission)

1. Press the clutch pedal fully.
2. Select **1st Gear**.
3. Release the parking brake.
4. Check all mirrors.
5. Check your blind spot.
6. Signal if required.
7. Slowly release the clutch until the **biting point** is reached.
8. Gently press the accelerator.
9. Release the clutch smoothly and continue accelerating.
- 10.

Tip: Smooth clutch control prevents the engine from stalling.

Moving Off (Automatic Transmission)

1. Press the **brake pedal**.
 2. Select **Drive (D)**.
 3. Release the parking brake.
 4. Check mirrors and blind spots.
 5. Signal if necessary.
 6. Slowly release the **brake pedal**.
 7. Press the accelerator gently and move off smoothly.
-

Stopping the Vehicle (Manual)

1. Check your mirrors.
 2. Signal if required.
 3. Release the accelerator.
 4. Press the brake pedal smoothly.
 5. Press the clutch pedal just before the vehicle stops.
 6. Shift into **Neutral**.
 7. Apply the parking brake if parking.
-

Stopping the Vehicle (Automatic)

1. Check your mirrors.
 2. Signal if required.
 3. Release the accelerator.
 4. Apply the brake smoothly.
 5. Keep the brake pedal pressed until the vehicle stops.
 6. Shift to **Park (P)** if parking.
 7. Apply the parking brake.
-

Common Beginner Mistakes

- Forgetting to fasten the seat belt.
 - Starting the engine while the vehicle is in gear.
 - Releasing the clutch too quickly.
 - Pressing the accelerator too hard.
 - Forgetting to check mirrors and blind spots.
 - Not releasing the parking brake before moving.
 - Stopping suddenly instead of braking smoothly.
-

Safety Tips

- Always look around before moving the vehicle.
- Use smooth pedal movements.
- Keep both hands on the steering wheel.
- Maintain a safe distance from other vehicles.
- Never rush when moving off or stopping.

Chapter Summary

Before continuing to Chapter 5, you should be able to:

- ☐ Start a manual transmission vehicle correctly.
- ☐ Start an automatic transmission vehicle correctly.
- ☐ Move off safely and smoothly.
- ☐ Stop the vehicle under full control.
- ☐ Perform all mirror, signal, and blind-spot checks before moving.

Remember: Smooth starts and controlled stops are the foundation of safe and confident driving.

Chapter 5 – Clutch Control & Gear Shifting (Manual Transmission)

Learning Objectives

After completing this chapter, you will be able to:

- Understand how the clutch works.
- Find and control the biting point.
- Change gears smoothly.
- Select the correct gear for different speeds.
- Avoid common gear-changing mistakes.

What Is the Clutch?

The clutch connects and disconnects the engine from the transmission, allowing you to change gears smoothly and stop the vehicle without stalling the engine.

Remember: Always press the clutch pedal fully before changing gears.

Understanding the Biting Point

The **biting point** is the position where the clutch begins to engage with the engine, causing the vehicle to start moving.

How to Find the Biting Point

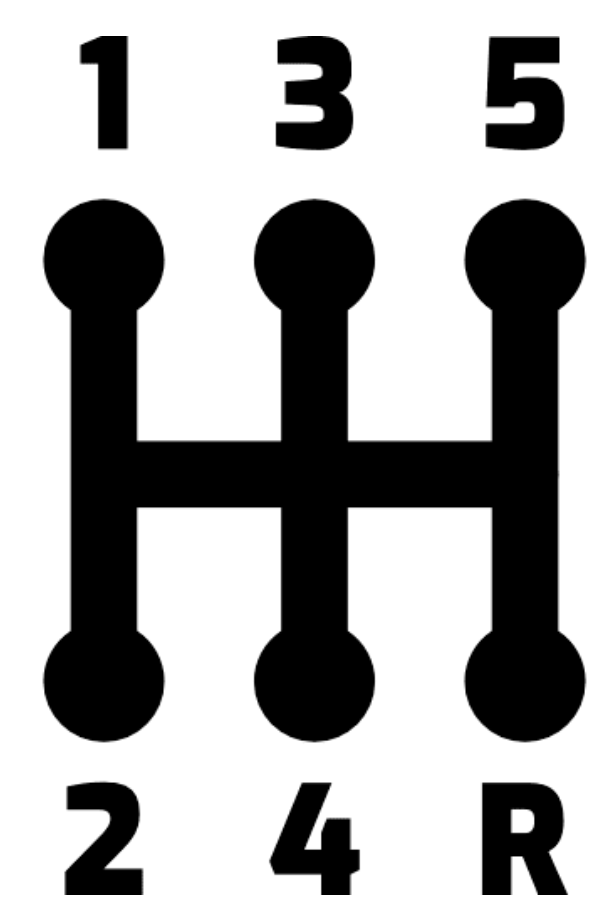
1. Start the engine.
2. Press the clutch pedal fully.
3. Select 1st Gear.
4. Release the parking brake.
5. Slowly release the clutch until you feel:
 - The front of the vehicle lift slightly.
 - A slight drop in engine speed.
 - The vehicle begin to move.

Hold the clutch briefly at this point, then gently press the accelerator and continue releasing the clutch smoothly.

Gear Shifting Procedure

To change gears correctly:

- Release the accelerator.
- Press the clutch pedal fully.
- Move the gear lever to the desired gear.
- Release the clutch smoothly.
- Press the accelerator gently.



Avoid rushing gear changes. Smooth movements improve comfort and reduce wear on the clutch.

Recommended Gear Speeds

Gear	Recommended Speed
1st Gear	0–15 km/h
2nd Gear	15–30 km/h
3rd Gear	30–50 km/h
4th Gear	50–70 km/h
5th Gear	Above 70 km/h

These are general guidelines. Always adjust your gear selection according to road conditions, traffic, and your vehicle's performance.

When to Shift Up

Shift to a higher gear when:

- The engine sounds loud.
- Engine RPM becomes high.
- The vehicle reaches the recommended speed for the current gear.

Higher gears improve fuel economy during steady driving.

When to Shift Down

Shift to a lower gear when:

- The vehicle slows down.
- Climbing a hill.
- Preparing to overtake.
- Entering a sharp turn.
- The engine struggles or vibrates due to low speed.

Clutch Control Tips

- Press the clutch pedal fully during every gear change.
- Release the clutch smoothly.
- Avoid resting your foot on the clutch pedal while driving.
- Use the clutch only when necessary.
- Keep your left foot on the footrest when not using the clutch.



Safety Tips

- Keep both hands on the steering wheel except while changing gears.
- Look ahead, not at the gear lever.
- Shift gears smoothly without forcing the gear lever.
- Practice clutch control in a safe, open area before driving in traffic.

Chapter Summary

Before continuing to Chapter 6, you should be able to:

- ☐ Explain the purpose of the clutch.
- ☐ Find and control the biting point.
- ☐ Change gears smoothly.
- ☐ Select the correct gear for different speeds.
- ☐ Avoid common clutch and gear-shifting mistakes.

Remember: Good clutch control is the key to smooth, safe, and confident manual driving.

Common Beginner Mistakes

- Releasing the clutch too quickly.
- Riding the clutch while driving.
- Looking at the gear lever while changing gears.
- Skipping gears without enough experience.
- Driving in the wrong gear for the vehicle's speed.
- Holding the vehicle on a hill using only the clutch.

Chapter 5 – Clutch Control & Gear Shifting (Manual Transmission)



Learning Objectives

After completing this chapter, you will be able to:

- Perform a safe uphill start in both manual and automatic vehicles.
 - Prevent the vehicle from rolling backward.
 - Select the correct gear while driving uphill and downhill.
 - Maintain full control of the vehicle on slopes.
 - Drive safely on steep roads.
-

Why Hill Driving Is Important

Driving on hills requires proper clutch control, braking, and gear selection. Incorrect technique can cause the vehicle to roll backward, stall, or lose control.

Always stay calm and use smooth pedal movements.

Uphill Start (Manual Transmission)

The handbrake method is the safest technique for beginners.

Steps

- Stop the vehicle and apply the parking brake.
- Press the clutch pedal fully.
- Select **1st Gear**.
- Gently press the accelerator (about **1,500–2,000 RPM**).
- Slowly release the clutch to the **biting point**.
- When the vehicle begins to pull forward, release the parking brake.
- Continue releasing the clutch smoothly while gently increasing acceleration.

Result: The vehicle moves forward smoothly without rolling backward.

Uphill Start Without the Handbrake

This method requires good clutch control.

Steps

- Press the clutch and brake pedals.
- Select **1st Gear**.
- Move your right foot quickly from the brake to the accelerator.
- Release the clutch slowly to the biting point.
- Press the accelerator gently.
- Continue releasing the clutch smoothly.

Note: Practice this method only after mastering the handbrake technique.

Uphill Driving

- Use a lower gear to maintain engine power.
- Accelerate smoothly.
- Keep a safe distance from the vehicle ahead.
- Avoid unnecessary gear changes on steep hills.

Downhill Driving

Use **engine braking** to control your speed.



Manual Transmission

- Select a lower gear before descending.
- Avoid driving downhill in **Neutral**.
- Use the brake pedal lightly when needed.

Automatic Transmission

- Select **L**, **2**, or another lower gear if available.
- Use the brake pedal gently.
- Maintain a safe speed throughout the descent.

Preventing Rollback

To avoid rolling backward:

- Use the parking brake on steep hills.
- Find the clutch biting point before releasing the parking brake.
- Apply gentle acceleration.
- Avoid releasing the clutch too quickly.

Common Beginner Mistakes

- Releasing the clutch too quickly.
- Releasing the parking brake too early.
- Using too much accelerator.
- Driving downhill in Neutral.
- Looking at the pedals instead of the road.
- Panicking if the vehicle stalls.

Safety Tips

- Keep a safe following distance on hills.
- Use lower gears for better control.
- Never coast downhill in Neutral.
- Stay calm and restart the engine safely if it stalls.
- Practice hill starts in a safe area before driving in traffic.

Chapter Summary

Before continuing to Chapter 7, you should be able to:

- ☐ Perform an uphill start using the parking brake.
- ☐ Prevent the vehicle from rolling backward.
- ☐ Select the correct gear for uphill and downhill driving.
- ☐ Descend hills safely using engine braking.
- ☐ Avoid common hill-driving mistakes.

Remember: Confidence on hills comes from smooth clutch control, proper gear selection, and staying calm under pressure.

SIGNS



